TURNING THE PAGE

Books you will need to clear shelf-space for in 2022



FICTION

RUN AND HIDE
by Pankaj Mishra (Juggernaut)
In his first novel since *The Romantics* (1999), Mishra tells the story of three IIT friends—Arun, Aseem and Virendra. While the first two choose to pursue wealth, Arun opts for literature and quiet.

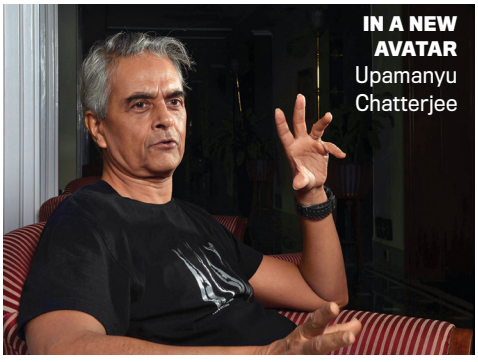
SOJOURN
by Amit Chaudhuri (Faber)
In 2005, an Indian writer arrives in Berlin. His disorientation only amplifies. Eventually, he says, "I've lost my bearings—not in the city; in its history. The less sure I become of it, the more I know my way."

CITY OF INCIDENT
by Annie Zaidi (Aleph)
Living in cities, we don't see our neighbours, much less those who live on urban peripheries. Zaidi's stories of 12 struggling men and women might well be a revelation.

THE LOVES OF YURI
by Jerry Pinto (Speaking Tiger)
Pinto's *Em and the Big Hoom* does have many fans. For them and us, news of his next novel is nothing short of thrilling. Set in 1980s Bombay, this is a story about friendship and first loves.

THE WOMAN ROBED WITH THE SUN *by K.R. Meera; translated by Ministhy (Penguin)*
In Meera's novel about Jezebel, a young Keralite doctor, we invariably hear echoes of her biblical namesake—both women have their backs against the wall and they both struggle hard to remain free.

EVERYTHING THE LIGHT TOUCHES
by Janice Pariat (HarperCollins)
As Pariat's characters travel continents, there is discovery at hand. Not all the epiphanies are personal, however. As botany comes to play a vital role in the novel, the lives of plants become portals to selves.



IN A NEW AVATAR
Upamanyu Chatterjee

CRIMSON SPRING
by Navtej Sarna (Aleph)
By choosing to fictionalise the Jallianwala Bagh massacre, Sarna, author and former diplomat, will make us revise our notion of history.

VILLAINY *by Upamanyu Chatterjee (Speaking Tiger)*
In Chatterjee's first crime novel, we are assured a body in the park, a wayward teenager and tense courtroom scenes.

THE LIVING MOUNTAIN
by Amitav Ghosh (HarperCollins)
It isn't just Ghosh's recent themes—greed, planetary collapse—that are urgent, but also the pace at which he is writing his books. This year, he will tell us a fable, that of Mahaparbat, the Living Mountain.

THE IMMORTAL KING RAO
by Vauhini Vara (HarperCollins)
A winner of the O. Henry Award, Vara seems to want to break all novelistic convention. She's written a book where everything from caste and memory to technology and climate change are key catalysts.

LOVE MARRIAGE
by Monica Ali (Hachette)
Shortlisted for a Booker in 2003, Ali's *Brick Lane* remains one of the more feted books to have ever come out of the South Asian diaspora. Her new social comedy is meant to be as moving and charming.

NIGHTS OF PLAGUE
by Orhan Pamuk; translated by Elkin Oklap (Faber)
For four years, Orhan Pamuk had been writing a novel set during the 1901 plague. Speaking of how strange he felt after Covid struck, Pamuk recently said, "It was like something you do secretly had shown up."

NON-FICTION

REBELS AGAINST THE RAJ Western Fighters for India's Freedom
by Ramachandra Guha (Allen Lane)
Not all of colonial India's relationships with the West were fraught. By telling us the story of seven foreigners who fought for our independence, Guha helps separate loyalty from unthinking patriotism.

AMBEDKAR A Life *by Shashi Tharoor (Aleph)*
This isn't the first time Tharoor has taken to biography. His *Nehru: The Invention of India* struck a fine balance between political and personal. He hopes to do the same with the life of B.R. Ambedkar.

IN THE LANGUAGE OF REMEMBERING
by Aanchal Malhotra (HarperCollins)
In her first book, *Remnants of a Separation*, Malhotra focussed on objects Partition survivors had carried across the border. In this, she asks—how did future generations remember this past?

AKBAR
by Parvati Sharma (Juggernaut)
Given the number of Akbar biographies